

AMERICAN RENEWAL INITIATIVE CANDIDATE ORIENTATION

How to Run on the American Renewal Agenda

A guide for any citizen who wants to carry this platform forward

No permission required.

No fee. No institutional relationship. No application process.

The American Renewal Agenda is a public platform. Any citizen may adopt it, run on it, and call themselves an ARA candidate. The ideas belong to anyone willing to fight for them.

What You Are Running On

The American Renewal Agenda is a governing blueprint, not a political slogan. It contains:

65

Policy proposals across 9 categories — each scored on Global Precedent, US Transition feasibility, and Societal Benefit.

12

Bills fully drafted in legislative language — specific legislation for every major position you take.

31

Proposals achievable through executive action — half the agenda requires no congressional vote.

Average score: 7.4 out of 10.

Framework v26, sourced-reconciled edition.

Three priority pillars: **Fix the Foundations** (healthcare, education, infrastructure) · **Same Rules for Everyone** (anti-corruption, accountability) · **Build What Lasts** (domestic manufacturing, energy independence, industrial capacity).

What Adopting This Platform Means

When you say you are running on the American Renewal Agenda, you are committing to the policy positions in the framework document. You are not committing to any organization, any other candidate, or any institutional relationship.

What the RDNC asks of you

→ Fidelity to the policy positions in the framework. Run on what the platform says, not a selective reading of it.

→ Intellectual honesty. If you disagree with a specific proposal, say so and explain why. Don't adopt the brand and abandon the substance.

→ Nothing else. No fee. No endorsement process. No required relationship with any RDNC official or organization.

What the RDNC does not do

→ Endorse candidates. Policy production and candidate endorsement are separate activities; we do only the former.

→ Fund campaigns. Your campaign is yours. Our funding and your funding are separate operations.

→ Control the platform. You cannot be removed from it. The framework is the reference point — publicly available for any voter to check.

How to Describe Your Relationship to the Movement

You will be asked about this. The answer is straightforward.

“I’m running on the American Renewal Agenda — a detailed governing platform developed by the Reform Democrats of the New Commonwealth. It’s publicly available. It has 65 specific proposals, twelve drafted bills, and a clear sequence for getting it done. I didn’t invent it, but I believe in it, and I’m committed to delivering it.”

What you should not say:

That you are an official RDNC candidate, that the RDNC is supporting your campaign, or that RDNC has endorsed you. None of these are true and they imply an institutional relationship that doesn’t exist.

What you can say:

That you are running on the ARA platform, that the platform is publicly available for anyone to examine, and that you are committed to the specific policies it contains. The specificity is the point. “I support the American Renewal Agenda” is more defensible than “I believe in change” because anyone who challenges it has to argue against specific, scored, researched proposals.

Your Campaign Identity Is Yours

The platform is fixed. Everything else is yours.

Your slogan, your logo, your ad design, your campaign voice — none of it is specified by the ARA or the RDNC. The policy positions are the accountability mechanism. The campaign that carries them is yours to build in the image of your district and your community. The ARI layer exists as public infrastructure, not a franchise. Use the branding if it serves you. Adapt it if it doesn’t. Build something entirely your own if that’s what your race requires. The only test is fidelity to the policy positions — not fidelity to any particular aesthetic or institutional look.

On the relationship to the Democratic Party: the ARA operates within the Democratic coalition without being owned by it. Running on this platform does not mean running against the party — it means running with a governing vision the party has been missing. You can be a Democrat, run on the ARA, and make both things true simultaneously. The Ideological Toolkit’s third diagnostic argument covers exactly how to frame this when you’re asked.

The Answers to Standard Attacks

“You’ll never get it through Congress.”

Half our agenda doesn’t go through Congress. On Day 1, the President can direct the DOJ, EPA, Department of Labor, and State Department to begin implementing 31 of our 65 proposals — immediately, without a single Senate vote. The diplomatic relationships. The Pentagon audit. The public health infrastructure restoration. The farm labor protections. These don’t require 60 votes. They require a President who actually wants to do them. The remaining 34 proposals go through Congress in sequence — we start with the ones that have the broadest support and build from there.

“This is too ambitious. You can’t do all of this.”

We’re not trying to do all of it at once. The platform has three phases over 30 years. Phase I is the five-year foundation — cost-of-living relief, anti-corruption, and infrastructure investment. These are specific, achievable, and broadly popular. We prove those work, then we expand. That’s not ambition — that’s sequencing.

“Who funds the organization behind this?”

No corporate donors. No institutional funding. No foreign government money. The research was produced independently. The platform belongs to anyone who adopts it — including me. If you want to know who’s behind this agenda, read it. Every proposal is scored and sourced. That’s the transparency.

“You’re just a regular person — why should anyone trust you to govern?”

Because I have a plan, not just a position. The politicians who’ve been in Congress for 30 years have had 30 years to fix this. What I have is a specific, researched, sequenced platform that tells you exactly what I’ll do and in what order. Judge me on the plan.

The Ecosystem — What to Read and In What Order

The full ARA ecosystem is an approximately 50-document library. You do not need to read all of it to run. The table below organizes it into three preparation tiers.

TIER 1 · Before any public appearance		
#	Document	What It Gives You
1	One-Pager	The 90-second version. Read this first. It is what voters see. If you can't defend everything on this page, you're not ready.
2	Timed Pitches	Scripted 15-second, 30-second, 1-minute, and 2-minute versions for every context from door-knock to debate stage. The positive case in your own words.
3	Ideological Toolkit	The core thesis, three principles, five diagnostics, and message discipline. The philosophical spine behind everything you say.
4	Attack-Answer Companion	20 common attacks with scripted answers and discipline notes. Read in full before your first interview, debate, or door-knock. Know it well enough to adapt it.
TIER 2 · Before debates and media		
#	Document	What It Gives You
5	Framework v26	All 65 proposals with descriptions and scores. Know your top 10 in depth; know where to find the rest.
6	Sequencing Map	The strategic logic: why this order, what's executive action, what requires legislation. The executive action section is your answer to "you need 60 votes."
7	Bill Glossary	The 12-bill summary. Know what each bill does and what phase it belongs to.
8	Comparison Documents	ARA vs P2025, ARA vs DNC 2024. Know the scores and the contrasts. These are your debate preparation materials.
TIER 3 · When they push hard		
#	Document	What It Gives You
9	Sourced Framework	Framework v26 with 297 inline source citations across 18 categories. Your answer to "the scoring is made up" — every score has a primary source behind it.
10	Capital Report	Full fiscal analysis: multipliers, scoring methodology, cost estimates, and comparisons to P2025 and DNC fiscal footprints. Your answer to "we can't afford this."
11	Scoring Justification	195 structured scoring paragraphs — one per axis per proposal across all 65. The full evidentiary record behind every number in the framework.

You don't need Tier 3 before your first door-knock. You need it before your first serious opposition.

Why This Platform Outlasts Any Candidate

Your support comes from your community — from the people who see the same problems you do and recognize that someone is finally naming them specifically. That support is real, and it is yours. The RDNC doesn't build it for you and it doesn't take it from you. If the ideas are good and beneficial to people, the people will say so. That is the only validation that matters.

What the platform gives you is a foundation that exists before you arrive and continues after you're done. The votes you earn are evidence of a constituency. The conversations at doors shift how people think. Communities that hear this argument have a name for what they've been asking for — and that name outlasts any single race.

The plan outlasts any candidate. That is the design — not to use people up, but to build something that compounds.

Every other candidate running on the ARA platform is doing the same work in a different district. Collectively, the movement builds proof that this agenda has electoral viability across many races and many cycles. You are not

alone in this, and you are not expendable. You are one of many people making the same honest case to their own communities.

Who Should Run

The conventional pipeline for political candidates runs through law school, local party committees, donor networks, and institutional endorsement. That pipeline has produced the Congress we have: a median age of 57 in the House, 64 in the Senate, dominated by Boomers governing problems they did not grow up with.

The ARA platform is designed to be picked up by people that pipeline would never select:

- A nurse who has watched the healthcare system fail patients and knows exactly what the public option needs to look like to actually work.
- A teacher who understands what the Scandinavian education model would require in practice and why the current system produces the outcomes it does.
- A veteran who has seen the military contractor capture problem from the inside and has the credibility to argue for reform without being dismissed as naive.
- A small business owner who has watched agricultural consolidation or corporate home-buying reshape their community and has standing to make the antitrust argument from lived experience.
- A millennial parent paying 40% of their income on childcare who can explain the cost cap proposal from their own kitchen table.

You do not need to be a lawyer. You do not need party institutional support. You need the platform — which you now have — and the willingness to make the case.

ARI — AMERICAN RENEWAL INITIATIVE

Healthcare. Education. Infrastructure.

Built to work.

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